

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Parents rankled by CPS-CTU bickering

Say children and education are taking back seat to politics

By Ikram Mohamed
Chicago Tribune

Despite having put five of her kids in Chicago Public Schools, Blaire Flowers said once her eldest daughter graduates high school, she may have to make the difficult decision of moving her children to a school district in the suburbs.

"It's not worth the fight," Flowers said. "My son is missing out on too much. You want me to sit here and wait while (teachers) scream and holler about wanting more money, and I'm still not getting the basic services my son should be getting from CPS."

Following months of turmoil that has consumed the district, some parents say they have had enough of the constant battling between the three groups leading the public school system. With district CEO Pedro Martinez's firing in December, upheaval on the school board and a four-year Chicago Teachers Union contract still being negotiated, some parents say their students have become an afterthought.

Various services her children needed have been ignored by the district, Flowers said, leading her to believe that negotiations have blinded the district and CTU. She believes it's difficult for parents to have a voice.

Growing up in the Austin neighborhood, Flowers said the Chicago Teachers Union was trying to protect students and educators. Now, sending her children to CPS, she feels the district and CTU disrespect parents, and the union is attempting to make parents "obsolete."

"It seems like CPS and the teachers union is like parents are down here ... under our shoes, and everyone else is up here," Flowers said.

Believing it's difficult for parents to have a voice in their children's education, Flowers said there are various services that her children have been asking for that have

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INSIDE



JACOB KUPFERMAN/AP

Buckeyes celebrate title and look ahead

Ohio State is early betting favorite to win next year's championship. But what will the sport be like when it kicks off again? **Chicago Sports**

More than just Taiwanese noodles

Minyoli in Andersonville was imagined as a noodle shop, but has become a creative cultural exploration. **Food & Health**

TODAY'S WEATHER

High 25
Low 15



Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 22

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
177th year No. 22
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Supporters gather on Tuesday outside the District of Columbia Detention Facility, the local jail in Washington, as they await the release of people charged in connection with the attack on the Capitol on Jan. 6, 2021. **GRAHAM DICKIE/THE NEW YORK TIMES**

President frees two leaders of sedition

Ex-leader of Proud Boys, founder of Oath Keepers part of sweeping pardons for 1,500

By Alanna Durkin Richer and Michael Kunzelman
Associated Press

WASHINGTON — The former leader of the Proud Boys and the founder of the Oath Keepers have been released from prison after their lengthy sentences for seditious conspiracy in the Jan. 6 attack on the U.S. Capitol were wiped away by a sweeping order from President Donald Trump benefiting more than 1,500 defendants.

Enrique Tarrio and Stewart Rhodes were two of the highest-profile Jan. 6 defendants and received some of the harshest punishments in what became the largest investigation in Justice Department history.

Rhodes, of Granbury, Texas, was serving an 18-year prison sentence, and Tarrio, of Miami, was serving a 22-year sentence after they were convicted of

orchestrating plots to stop the peaceful transfer of power after Trump, a Republican, lost the 2020 election to Democrat Joe Biden.

Their attorneys confirmed Tuesday that they had been released hours after Trump pardoned, commuted the sentences of, or ordered the dismissal of cases against all the 1,500-plus people who were charged with federal crimes in the riot. Trump's action paved the way for the release of extremist group leaders convicted in major conspiracy cases, as well people who violently attacked law enforcement officers defending the Capitol.

More than 200 people convicted of Jan. 6 crimes were released from federal Bureau of Prisons custody by Tuesday morning, officials told The

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Joe Leyden shows his support during a Donald Trump inauguration watch party at Danny's Pizza Place in Chicago on Monday. He was arrested in the Jan. 6 Capitol attack and sentenced to six months behind bars. His Brother Daniel Leyden was also arrested and was sentenced to more than three years in federal prison. **ANTONIO PEREZ/TRIBUNE**

INSIDE: Feds begin dismissing Jan. 6 cases against Illinoisans after Trump issues blanket pardon. **Chicagoland, Page 4**

■ Tariffs could test relationship between Canada and Illinois. **Business**



No temporary workers stand at the entryway or along the fence surrounding the Home Depot along North Cicero Avenue in Chicago in the frigid weather Tuesday. **STACEY WESCOTT/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Immigrants stay home, hunker down

'People are hiding' due to threats of mass deportations

By Laura Rodríguez Presa, Talia Soglin and Nell Salzman
Chicago Tribune

When reports surfaced over the weekend that mass deportations could potentially begin in the Chicago area Tuesday, Martin Ramos informed his

boss that he was taking time off from work, stocked up on groceries and decided his kids would skip soccer practice this week.

Ramos — who emigrated from Guadalajara, Mexico, without the necessary work permits — spent the first full day of Donald Trump's second presidency hunkered down with his family and trying to avoid being picked up by ICE agents. An arrest, he knows, would destroy everything he

and his wife worked for and force their two boys into an uncertain future.

"We have to do everything possible to keep our children safe," Ramos told Tribune. "What will they do if we get deported?"

ICE agents did not show up at the Joliet factory where Ramos and his wife both work Tuesday, but the fear inflicted upon employees there was

Turn to Immigrants, Page 2

Illinois joins in lawsuit challenging Trump order

Raoul says kids born in US to immigrants entitled to citizenship

By Olivia Olander
Chicago Tribune

Illinois joined three Western states on Tuesday in a lawsuit challenging the constitutionality of President Donald Trump's executive order ending birthright citizenship.

"The children born in the U.S. to immigrants are entitled to the rights and privileges that go along with U.S. citizenship," Illinois Attorney General Kwame Raoul said in a news release.

A separate lawsuit against the order, aimed at the children of non-U.S. citizens, was filed in Massachusetts by 18 other states. Raoul's office didn't immediately respond to a question about why he signed onto the lawsuit filed in federal court in Seattle along with the states of Washington, Arizona and Oregon.

The lawsuit argues the president can't decide who should be granted citizenship at birth or override the

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